

CHUKWUMA ZIKORA

Senior Software Engineer | Full-Stack & Platform Infrastructure

Anambra, Nigeria • +234 703 131 0606 • chukwuma.zikora@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/chukwumazikora • github.com/chukwumaijem • chukwumaijem.github.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and Platform Engineer with 10+ years of software engineering experience and a strong specialisation in infrastructure automation, CI/CD pipeline design, cloud architecture, and container orchestration. Proven record designing and operating deployment infrastructure for healthcare-grade SaaS systems.

Additionally, an independent product builder with two live SaaS products shipped end-to-end, from architecture through deployment, serving the African market.

Currently preparing for CKAD certification to formalise existing Kubernetes knowledge.

CORE SKILLS

Container & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

CI/CD & Automation: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, CircleCI, Ansible

Backend Engineering: Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, REST APIs, GraphQL (Hasura & Apollo), microservices

Frontend Engineering: TypeScript, React.js, Next.js, Vue.js, Vuex, Pinia, Redux

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, TursoDB, Prisma, DrizzleORM, Sequelize

Testing: Jest, Playwright, Vitest

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS — BlockQueue Systems Ltd

Founder of BlockQueue Systems Limited. Built and shipped two production SaaS platforms as sole or lead engineer, handling product architecture, full-stack development, infrastructure design, and cloud deployment independently.

Lead Engineer - Property Governors

2025 - Present

propertygovernors.com

Stack: Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Paystack/Monnify/KongaPay

- Architected and built a multi-sided property management SaaS platform from zero — serving landlords, property managers, tenants, and maintenance vendors from a single codebase.
- Designed and implemented role-based access control across four distinct user roles with separate dashboards and permission scopes.
- Integrated multiple payment providers (Paystack, Monnify, KongaPay) via a BYOK (Bring Your Own Keys) model, enabling landlords to collect rent online through their own merchant accounts.
- Built financial tracking, lease management, maintenance request workflows, inspection scheduling, and analytics/reporting modules end-to-end.
- Designed and managed all cloud infrastructure and deployment pipelines; application is live and serving active users across Nigeria.

Lead Engineer - FirmLyt

2024 - Present

firmlyt.com Stack: Next.js, Nodejs, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker, AI/LLM integration

- Co-architected a legal practice management SaaS platform built for the Nigerian market, covering case management, client portals, contract lifecycle management, team calendaring, and AI-powered legal research.
 - Integrated AI/LLM capabilities for Nigerian case law search and citation automation across Supreme Court and Court of Appeal decisions.
 - Implemented digital signature workflows, contract template engines, and document management with automated renewal reminders.
 - Built a website module with SEO optimisation, allowing law firms to publish their own presence through the platform.
 - Handled end-to-end infrastructure design, CI/CD setup, and cloud deployment on AWS.
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OPEN SOURCE — github.com/blockqueue

Publishes production-grade infrastructure tooling under the BlockQueue organisation on GitHub. Open source work reflects the same engineering standards applied across commercial products.

Mailer

2025 – Present

github.com/blockqueue/mailer

TypeScript | Apache-2.0

- Designed and built a self-hostable email orchestration microservice serving as centralised email infrastructure across all BlockQueue products — cleanly separating email delivery concerns from application logic.
- Implemented dual authentication models: API key authentication for internal services and HMAC-SHA512 request signing with replay-attack prevention for public-facing deployments.
- Built a pluggable renderer architecture supporting React Email, MJML, and HTML templates, with JSON Schema-based payload validation at startup and runtime.
- Added production-grade security features: IP allowlisting with CIDR support, configurable rate limiting with sliding window algorithm, HTTPS enforcement, and PII-safe audit logging.
- Containerised with Docker; YAML-driven configuration with full environment variable substitution enables zero-code deployment across different environments.

BQ Queue

2026 – Present

github.com/blockqueue/bq-queue

TypeScript | Apache-2.0

- Designed and built a self-hostable job queue and HTTP webhook delivery service — providing a single, centralised scheduling layer across all BlockQueue products without each service implementing its own queue.
- Built on pg-boss (PostgreSQL-backed job queues) with per-queue worker registration; workers deliver signed HTTP POST requests to configurable downstream endpoints, enabling reliable fan-out to internal microservices.
- Implemented dual HMAC-SHA512 signing: incoming requests to the API are signed with a shared secret; outbound worker deliveries are signed per-queue with separate secrets, so downstream services can verify the caller independently.
- Designed idempotency guarantees via a dedicated PostgreSQL schema — one-off and scheduled jobs are deduplicated by idempotency key, with clean replace semantics on resubmission.
- YAML-driven multi-project configuration with environment variable substitution; multiple projects share a single pg-boss instance with independent per-queue retention, retry policies, concurrency limits, and cleanup schedules.
- Full Docker Compose setup including PostgreSQL, pg-boss dashboard, and the queue service; Drizzle ORM schema and migration tooling included for production database management.
- Comprehensive test suite covering unit and HTTP integration tests; Turborepo monorepo structure with shared ESLint and TypeScript configs.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | [ShiftHealth](#)

July 2020 – Present

Remote | Healthcare automation platform (Zapier-style integration engine)

- Designed and built the CI/CD pipeline infrastructure using GitHub Actions and Docker, reducing deployment cycle time and eliminating manual deployment errors across a multi-environment healthcare platform.
- Migrated critical system components from traditional server infrastructure to AWS Serverless (Lambda, API Gateway), improving cost-efficiency and enabling elastic scaling for variable workloads.
- Designed and implemented microservices architecture for the team and user management system, improving service isolation, scalability, and independent deployability.
- Built and maintained a library of healthcare system connectors and integration workflows, enabling automated data exchange between clinical and administrative platforms.
- Automated repetitive QA and regression workflows using Selenium IDE and WebDriver, eliminating manual testing overhead on each release cycle.
- Optimised frontend state management architecture, measurably reducing application latency and improving stability under concurrent usage.
- Currently responsible for deployment supervision across fully automated infrastructure; all deployment pipelines are self-designed and self-maintained.

Software Engineer | [Unbird](#)

July 2019 – June 2020

Remote

- Built a drag-and-drop interface that significantly improved user engagement and reduced task completion time for end users.
- Developed a real-time notification system using WebSockets, increasing user retention through timely in-app and push alerts.
- Implemented granular team permission controls, ensuring secure, role-scoped data access across multi-tenant workspaces.

Freelance JavaScript Developer | [Kwhen](#)

September 2017 – June 2019

Remote | Event curation platform

- Integrated multiple third-party event partner APIs to aggregate and consolidate event data, expanding platform content coverage.
- Implemented advanced search algorithms and filter logic, delivering faster and more accurate event discovery for users.
- Delivered feature enhancements that measurably improved user experience and engagement metrics across the platform.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka

B.Sc. Computer Science - Second Class Honours (Upper Division)

Udacity | July 2022

Cloud DevOps Engineering Nanodegree

In View | Linux Foundation | Expected 2026

CKAD — Certified Kubernetes Application Developer